

665 665 786 - JESU, MEINE FREUDE
(Jesus, Priceless Treasure - LSB 743)

1. To the garden splendid
Adam well attended,
e'er contently worked.
Yet, in forest verdant,
thither where the serpent
ominously lurked,
in the lush, there came a hush;
then the figures, shamed, dispersèd.
Lo, and they were cursèd!

2. Once were flowers thornless,
conifers adorned with
branch and needle fair.
From the fruit-tree's sweetness
Adam showed his weakness,
caught in Satan's snare.
Mixed with mud, his crimson blood
stained the garden, now much rougher;
henceforth man would suffer.

3. Though his nature severed,
vainly man endeavored
to fulfillment make.
Toiled he in sorrow
through each barren morrow
until, for his sake,
stood on sod the Son of God,
walked amongst His own creation
through the vegetation.

4. He on us had favor,
bore with us our labor,
took on Adam's curse:
ev'ry thorn and splinter,
felt the cold of winter,
hunger bore, and thirst.
Yea, He met the taste of sweat,
humbled His own godly merit,
but for us would share it.

5. On the cross He hangèd,
and, with body languid,
to His Father cried.

Lo, with quakes of thunder,
heaven rent asunder!
On the cross He died.
Tangled thorn His brow adorned.
Thus for us His duty tended:
He our nature mended.

6. To the tree entangled;
His own body mangled;
blood drips from His feet.
Ah! The crimson juices
from the tree produce His
precious wine, so sweet.
Hanging, He, upon the tree,
is the vine and we His members;
life to us He renders.

7. Branches, we, abiding;
He in us confiding
His own blood for wine.
Grace, so freely granted,
in our hearts is planted
in the feast divine.
From His veins new life we gain
but through means most sacramental.
Oh, His love, so gentle!

8. Oh! What great oblation,
through our own vocation,
Thou shalt sanctify.
Bless us in our labors,
help us serve our neighbors
now and till we die.
Then, though dust, we will, we trust,
walk, with all Thy righteous pardon,
back to Eden's garden.